

What this build would cost

An illustrative costing for the Drain Pros TN website at 2026 market rates. Scope figures are measured from the finished repository. Rates are industry ranges rather than surveyed data - see the note on the final page.

1. What was actually built

Measure	Delivered
Pages built and deployed	82
Route groups	5 (services, service areas, problems, guides, core)
Original copy written	approx. 32,000 words
Source files / lines	42 files, 10,088 lines of TypeScript and TSX
Service registry	17 services, each with license scope and permit flags
Location registry	20 towns, each bound to a permit jurisdiction
Jurisdiction map	14 permitting authorities, individually verified
Structured data	7-node JSON-LD graph across every page
Compliance tooling	Custom build-time linter, 10 checks, blocks deploys

2. Effort by discipline

Workstream	Hours
Discovery, positioning and competitor analysis Eighteen competitors reviewed, market tiered, service and jurisdiction model built	20 - 40
Information architecture and content modelling Five route groups, registry-driven so pages cannot drift from the data	15 - 25
Design system Tokens, type scale, component library, the spec-sheet credential treatment	30 - 50
Front-end build Next.js 15 App Router, TypeScript strict, Tailwind, fully static	60 - 100
Compliance architecture Fact registry, scope guard, publishing policy, build-time linter	25 - 40
SEO and structured data layer JSON-LD graph, sitemap, canonicals, FAQ and breadcrumb nodes	20 - 30
Copywriting approx. 32,000 words, hand-written, local research per town	80 - 140

Conversion and integrations Lead form, Housecall Pro booking, CTA hierarchy, mobile action bar	12 - 20
QA, accessibility and deployment Cross-device checks, build verification, Vercel pipeline	15 - 25
Total	277 - 470

3. What that costs, by who builds it

Who	Rate	Low	High
Independent contractor Senior freelancer, direct, no overhead	\$100/hr	\$27,700	\$47,000
Boutique studio Small team, strategy plus build	\$175/hr	\$48,475	\$82,250
Full-service agency Account management, specialists per discipline	\$275/hr	\$76,175	\$129,250

For a trades business this size, the boutique studio column is the realistic comparison: roughly **\$48,475 to \$82,250**. An agency would not usually take a single-location trades client at this scope, and a contractor working alone would rarely carry the strategy and the compliance architecture as well as the build.

4. Why this is not a \$6,000 website

Most trades websites sold in this market are 8 to 15 pages on a template, with copy reworded from the last client in the same trade, priced somewhere around \$3,000 to \$9,000. That is a real product and for many businesses it is the right one. Three things make this build a different line item.

Volume of original content. Around 32,000 words, written for this business, with per-town material - which utility serves it, the housing stock era, septic versus city sewer. Copy at that depth is the single largest cost in the table above, and it is exactly what a template package does not include.

Compliance architecture. A registry where every business fact carries a confirmed or pending status, a scope guard that decides what may be advertised where, and a build-time linter that refuses to deploy if an unverified claim or a home address ever reaches the source. That is custom software, not a page builder, and it exists because the downside for a licensed trade is a license, not a ranking.

Structured data done properly. A linked JSON-LD graph across all 82 pages rather than a plugin dropping a generic LocalBusiness block on the home page.

5. Not included

- Domain registration and email hosting (roughly \$15 to \$40 a year)
- Photography and video - this build used the client's own images
- Logo and brand identity design - supplied by the client

- Google Business Profile setup, verification and ongoing management
- Review generation programme - the single largest ongoing cost driver
- Paid advertising, ad management, and any media spend
- Ongoing content production after launch
- Call tracking numbers and CRM licensing

6. Ongoing, after launch

Item	Typical	Note
Hosting	\$0 to \$20 a month	Vercel free tier covers a static site this size
Domain	\$15 to \$40 a year	Registration and renewal
Content retainer	\$500 to \$2,500 a month	Two to six new pages a month, optional
Review generation	\$200 to \$800 a month	Software plus process; the thing that cannot be rushed
Technical maintenance	\$150 to \$600 a month	Dependency updates, monitoring, small fixes

The review programme is the line worth reading twice. Reaching the top of this market takes roughly 250 to 350 genuine reviews over about two years. At 15 to 20 jobs a week that is achievable, but only if it starts now - it is the one cost that cannot be compressed by spending more.

7. Basis of these figures

Read this part before quoting any number above to anyone.

Scope is measured. Rates are estimated. Every figure in section 1 was counted from the finished repository. The hourly rates in section 3 are not - they are commonly quoted ranges for US web work at senior level, not a surveyed 2026 rate card. No pricing study was consulted in producing this document.

Rates vary widely by region and by who is asking. The same scope quoted in a major metro versus southeast Tennessee can differ by half. Treat the columns as a spread, not a price.

Hours are informed estimates. They reflect the shape of the delivered work rather than a tracked timesheet. The copywriting line carries the most uncertainty, because writing 32,000 words of researched trade copy varies enormously with how much research the writer actually does.

In short: the scope is real, the pricing is a well-informed illustration, and it is offered as a sense of scale rather than a quote.